



Questionnaire: McCarroll's Automotive Group - Kinghorn Motor Group & Country Motor Company

MN-65026

Deadline to respond: 29 July 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) is currently assessing McCarroll's of Moss Vale Pty Ltd's (**McCarroll's**) proposed acquisition of substantially all of the assets of the motor vehicle dealership businesses owned by Kinghorn Motors Pty Ltd (**Kinghorn Motors**) and Country Motor Company Pty Ltd (**Country Motors**) (the **Acquisition**).

For further information about the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, see the ACCC's [Acquisitions Register](#).

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisition on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information in response to the questions below by **29 July 2026** via email to mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: McCarroll's – Kinghorn Motors & Country Motors*. The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: McCarroll's – Kinghorn Motors & Country Motors*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.
- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's [general confidentiality claims template](#)). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

Questions

Questions for all respondents

1. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any commercial relationships with McCarroll's, Kinghorn Motors and/or Country Motors.

2. Do you consider Kinghorn Motors and Country Motors are close competitors for the supply of new cars? If so, please provide reasons why.

3. In the Nowra area and broader Illawarra region, provide an overview of alternative suppliers of new cars?

Questions for new car dealerships

4. Identify your strongest dealership competitors and specify the original equipment manufacturer (**OEM**) brands that these competitors represent. As part of your response, explain what makes them strong competitors to you (e.g. OEM brand, price, range, proximity, service levels).

5. To what extent do dealerships offering the same OEM brand compete? For example, how closely do you compete with dealerships that have distribution agreements with the same OEM brand(s) as your dealership?

6. To what extent do dealerships offering different OEM brands compete? For example, how closely does a Ford dealership compete with a Hyundai dealership? Or a Volkswagen dealership and a Isuzu Ute dealership?

7. For any new car dealerships you operate in the Illawarra region, specify the distances or drive times your customers travel to purchase a new car.

If you do not operate any new car dealerships in the Illawarra region, please respond to the above based on other dealerships you operate in surrounding areas, such as the Southern Highlands, the South Coast, Greater Sydney, or elsewhere in New South Wales.

Question for all respondents

8. Provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition.

Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's [confidentiality quick guide](#).